WRITTEN EXAM ASSIGNMENT FOR SYSTEMS DEVELOPMENT IN PRAXIS

The assignment is individual and should be submitted in the digital exam system: www.de.aau.dk/studerende/

The course is 5 ECTS, and the exam is graded on the 7-point scale with an internal censor. Deadline for submitting is June 15th 2026 at 4 PM.

The student is assigned to write a short paper that reports a theory-directed analysis of a documented systems development praxis (Norlys). The student must choose a theory from those presented in the course (e.g., Mintzberg's organization theory).

The conclusion of the theory-directed analysis must include an answer to a problem statement relevant to both theory and praxis. Moreover, the student should relate and discuss the answer with one or more of the other theories presented in the course but not used for the analysis.

The short paper must include a title and an abstract of no more than 150 words. The required length is 4 - 5 standard pages, excluding abstract, figures, and references. A standard page is 2400 characters, including spacing, or approximately 360 words. The paper can be written in Danish or English.

AI-based tools (e.g. ChatGPT) are allowed to assist in idea generation, data analysis, grammar, text condensation, and text critique. However, generic text that is insufficiently grounded in the unique empirical material gathered from Norlys and the theories discussed in the course *will not receive a passing grade according to the assessment criteria*. These assessment criteria are as follows:

- Clarity of the argument for the problem statement's relevance and the choice of theory used to address it.
- Correctness and precision in the account of the chosen theory.
- Transparent and systematic application of the chosen theory for the analysis of praxis.
- Traceability from the short paper's overall conclusions to statements in the empirical material.
- Explicit discussion of the results from the analysis with at least one other theory from the course that was not used for the analysis.